

114 Prefixes

Prefixes are small groups of letters which can be added to the start of many words to give them different meanings.

See also:

Types of verbs 49

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114.1 PREFIXES

Prefixes attach to the start of a word to change its meaning. Prefixes usually give the same change in meaning to each word they attach to.

im- = not

Polly thought her boss was very rude and **im**polite.



mis- = wrongly

Leona was worried that she had **mis**understood the recipe.



re- = again

Tom was **re**writing his essay because his teacher gave him a low grade.



un- = not

Jane is **un**likely to study history because she prefers science.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

This exercise is too hard.
It's completely **im**possible!



Brendan had **mis**placed his passport.
He couldn't find it anywhere.



I didn't work very hard this year.
I'll have to **re**take my exams.



Please clean up your desk.
It's very **un**tidy.



A fear of ghosts is totally **irr**ational, they don't exist!



You should go to see the new
exhibit. It's absolutely **out**standing.

